

THE SESSION • POST-CLOSE READ

A Dovish *Reprieve*

Fed Governor Waller's willingness to hold rates steady reset the September calculus, yields and the dollar eased, and stocks staged a broad advance into Friday's payrolls. Both sleeves finished ahead of their primary benchmarks.

S&P 500 ▲ 1.07%

NASDAQ ▲ 1.40%

DOW ▲ 1.18%

VIX 14.28

BRENT ▲ \$96

DIVIDEND STRATEGY

▲ BEAT DVY • TRAILED SPY

+0.69%

1-DAY

FCI		+0.69%
DVY		+0.60%
SPY		+1.04%

YTD +22.61% vs DVY +18.71% • SPY +13.98%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO

▲ BEAT IUSG + SPY

+2.57%

1-DAY

FCI		+2.57%
IUSG		+1.31%

YTD +23.78% vs IUSG +14.69%

THE SESSION

One patient voice reset the week's rate math. Speaking at a Reuters event Thursday morning, Fed Governor Christopher Waller said he would lean toward holding rates steady at the September 15–16 meeting absent an upside inflation surprise — a counterweight to Chair Warsh's harder line, and one the market took at face value. Treasury yields eased from the week's multiyear highs, the dollar declined against the yen, and equities advanced across the board: the S&P 500 rose 1.07% in what Yahoo Finance called its best session since August 4, the Nasdaq gained 1.40%, and the Dow added 1.18% for its strongest day in about a month, per the same coverage. The VIX settled at 14.28.

The morning's data cooperated without complicating the story. Initial jobless claims came in at 206,000 against a 205,000 consensus, holding the historically low range they have occupied all year, and the ISM Services index printed 55.4 versus roughly 54.3 expected — a twenty-sixth consecutive month of expansion, with business activity at 61.7 and new orders at 60.9. Prices paid, at 71.3, remain the hawks' exhibit. Firm-but-not-hot is precisely the mix a patient Fed needs, and rate-sensitive assets responded in kind: gold rose about 2% toward \$4,440, bitcoin climbed past \$80,000, and Brent held near \$96 as U.S.–Iran hostilities kept a floor under crude. Wednesday's custom-silicon repricing, meanwhile, spent itself quietly — CRDO closed off just 0.64% after the prior session's reset.

We do not own the Fed's next vote. We own businesses that compound through it — and days like this are the market remembering that patience is also a policy.

The Growth Portfolio (Growth Portfolio) captured the day's character, rising 2.57% against IUSG's +1.31% and SPY's +1.04% — leadership came from HOOD, the bitcoin miners, NOW, and AEM (+5.40%),

which rode gold's advance. The Digital Asset ETFs kept pace, with IBIT up 5.85% and ETHA up 5.37% (Digital Asset ETF). The Dividend Strategy's +0.69% edged DVY's +0.60% while trailing SPY on a day

built for higher-beta fare; SPGI, TEL (+3.57%), and FAST (+2.71%) led, while healthcare names ABT (−1.52%) and SYK (−1.35%) lagged. Year to date, the Dividend Strategy stands +3.90 points clear of DVY at

+22.61%, and the Growth Portfolio +9.09 points clear of IUSG at +23.78% — margins earned by owning, not by timing.

FCI HOLDINGS · NOTABLE MOVERS

WINNERS

HOOD +16.57%

GROWTH

Rode bitcoin's move above \$80,000 and a string of constructive analyst notes — Morgan Stanley's upgrade to Overweight with a \$150 target this week highlighted the prediction-markets business.

MARA +10.79%

GROWTH

Bitcoin miners advanced with the coin as receding rate-hike odds revived risk appetite across the digital-asset complex.

HUT +9.18%

GROWTH

Joined the miners' advance on the same bitcoin bid, recovering a portion of its late-August pullback.

DECLINERS

HRMY −2.33%

GROWTH

Faded from an intraday peak in a consolidation of its strong summer advance; no adverse company news crossed.

FCX −1.83%

GROWTH

Slipped from an intraday high above \$75 even as copper firmed — a pause near the top of its 52-week range.

NOW +6.45%

GROWTH

Extended the enterprise-software re-rating as the sector rallied broadly; recent price-target raises from Bank of America and Wells Fargo continue to be absorbed.

SPGI +4.38%

DIVIDEND

Added to its advance on reported interest in a Capital IQ Pro separation, with easing yields a constructive backdrop for ratings issuance.

CEG −1.72%

DIVIDEND

Retraced part of its recent advance as the session's leadership rotated toward rate-sensitive and digital-asset names.

NXPI −1.54%

GROWTH

Lagged a mixed semiconductor tape in which gains concentrated in AI-levered names over autos-exposed analog.

HOLDINGS NEWS

HOOD — upgrade cycle builds around prediction markets.

Morgan Stanley upgraded Robinhood (Growth Portfolio) to Overweight this week and lifted its target to \$150 from \$124, citing the prediction-markets franchise; Piper Sandler followed to \$145 and Scotiabank initiated at Outperform, per TipRanks. With bitcoin above \$80,000, the platform's volume-levered model carried Thursday's tape.

SPGI — portfolio streamlining draws a constructive read. S&P

Global (Dividend Strategy) extended its multi-session advance on reported interest in separating the Capital IQ Pro platform; Wells Fargo called a possible spinoff a positive amid rising AI competition, per TipRanks. Easing yields add a friendlier backdrop for the ratings franchise into the fourth quarter.

YEAR-TO-DATE STANDING

DIVIDEND STRATEGY

+22.61%

vs DVY +18.71% / SPY +13.98%

Spread vs DVY **+3.90 pts**

GROWTH PORTFOLIO

+23.78%

vs IUSG +14.69%

Spread vs IUSG **+9.09 pts**